

August 2026

Dear Christopher,

I've worked in Lamorinda for a long time, and the homes that stop me are the ones where someone clearly cared - where you can see a genuine point of view in every room. 285 Camino Pablo is one of those homes. The combination of redwood setting, golf course views, and the kind of kitchen and outdoor space that took real thought to put together is not something you find often at this price point in Orinda. When the listing came off market after 140 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out because I think the home deserved a better outcome than it got.

A property like this one - updated with intention, set on a 15,810 square foot lot surrounded by mature redwoods, with views of Orinda Country Club and a long list of genuinely useful features - should not have sat for nearly five months. At \$610 per square foot, this home was priced well below the Orinda range for renovated properties, which means the gap between what the home offered and what buyers understood about it was a strategy problem, not a value problem. The listing gave buyers a list of features. It never gave them a reason to feel the home.

I've put together a short analysis of the three specific places where I believe the strategy fell short, along with what a relaunch would need to do differently to get this property in front of the right buyers and give them the context to act. It's in the pages that follow - no obligation, just a clear picture of where things stand and what I'd recommend.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside - I mean that sincerely. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation at whatever pace works for you. You can reach me at (925) 255-9727 whenever you're ready.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a stylized flourish extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates
(925) 255-9727 · brightworkrealty.com
455 Moraga Road, Suite I · Moraga, CA 94556

The Path to Sold:

285 Camino Pablo

Orinda, CA 94563

3.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,048 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 285 Camino Pablo

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Thoughtfully Renovated Orinda Home with Redwood Setting and Golf Course Views - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

285 Camino Pablo has the ingredients that Lamorinda buyers actively search for: a renovated kitchen with dark quartz counters, heated floors, and real cabinetry; hardwood floors throughout; a primary suite with a steam shower; and an outdoor environment built for actual living - redwood canopy, blue tile pathways, speakers wired for entertaining, and views of Orinda Country Club. The lot runs to 15,810 square feet, which is meaningful space in a city where usable outdoor living is increasingly hard to find. The 1951 bones have been updated with a genuine aesthetic sensibility, not a builder-grade flip.

The listing history doesn't match those assets. 140 days on market at \$610 per square foot - well below the Orinda benchmark of \$790 to \$850 for a renovated property - tells a story of a home that buyers couldn't quite connect with, not a home that was mispriced. The description covered the feature inventory but never built the case for why this specific combination of setting, renovation quality, and location commands attention. Buyers comparing options at this price point needed more than a checklist. They needed to understand what they were walking into before they ever drove up the driveway.

\$1,249,000

List Price

\$610/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to accomplish one thing: close the gap between what the property actually delivers and what buyers understood about it during the first listing. That means leading with the setting and the views, telling the renovation story with visual depth, and reaching the buyers - particularly professionals relocating from San Francisco and Oakland - who shop Orinda online before they ever schedule a showing.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 140 Days and a Stigma the Home Didn't Earn

Past the 45-day mark, buyer behavior changes. Instead of evaluating what a home offers, buyers start asking what's wrong with it. At 140 days, that skepticism is deeply set - and it compounds with every week the listing stays active. 285 Camino Pablo didn't earn that skepticism. A 15,810 square foot redwood lot, golf course views, a renovated kitchen with heated floors, and a steam shower in the primary suite are genuine differentiators. But the listing never actively found the buyers who would recognize that. It waited. The right buyer was likely out there the whole time - the strategy just never reached them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put this home in front of San Francisco and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Orinda before they've committed to a search - reaching decision-makers where they are, rather than waiting for them to find the listing.

Friction #2: The Visual Story of This Property Was Never Told

A redwood canopy setting, blue tile pathways, views of Orinda Country Club from the driveway, and a finished outdoor entertaining space with speakers and projector capability - these are features that live or die on photography and visual presentation. Standard MLS angles capture rooms. They don't capture the feeling of a property like this one, where the setting and the outdoor environment are as compelling as the interior. At \$1,249,000, buyers comparing against other Orinda options need to feel the difference before they commit to a showing. Without the visual depth to communicate what makes this property distinct, it reads as a competent renovation on a nice street - which undersells it significantly.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures aerial neighborhood context and lot position in ways no ground photograph can - giving buyers an immediate, visceral sense of this setting, the redwood canopy, and the relationship to Orinda Country Club before they ever step out of the car.

Friction #3: A Price That Needed a Story to Support It

At \$610 per square foot, this home was priced at the low end of Orinda's renovated range, which runs from \$790 to \$850 per square foot for updated properties. That gap is not a problem - it's actually an argument for value. But only if the marketing makes the case. When a listing reads as a feature inventory rather than a narrative, buyers at this price point don't know what they're comparing. They see \$1,249,000, they see a 1951 home, and they move on to something that feels more immediately legible. The renovation quality, the lot, and the views absolutely support the number. The listing never built that case for buyers who needed it made.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement pairs an enhanced listing narrative with premium portal visibility, so buyers encountering this home for the first time get the full context - not just a price and a photo count - and arrive at a showing already understanding what makes it worth their time.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	285 Camino Pablo	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$610/sqft	Renovated / updated: \$790–\$850/sqft
Lot / Setting	15,810 sqft with redwood canopy, blue tile pathways, golf course views	Typical Orinda lot: 8,000–12,000 sqft, standard landscaping
Architectural Character	1951 original structure, renovated with intentional design, vaulted ceilings with beams	Standard updated rancher or split-level, builder-grade finishes
Premium Features	Heated kitchen and primary suite floors, steam shower, gourmet kitchen with dark quartz, smart home integration, finished garage, bonus shed/office	Standard floor plan, updated kitchen and baths
HOA	None	Varies; many Orinda communities carry \$0–\$150/mo

The verdict: At \$610/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$790-\$850/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$610 per square foot, this home is priced well below the low end of Orinda's renovated range, which starts at \$790 per square foot. The lot size, renovation quality, and golf course views objectively support a stronger position in the market. The gap between the list price and the benchmark is not a liability - it's an opportunity, but only if the marketing gives buyers the context to understand what they're getting. A relaunch built around the right visual presentation and targeted distribution can close that gap in buyer perception before the first showing.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Lead with the Setting, Not the Spec Sheet

The redwood canopy, the views of Orinda Country Club, and the outdoor entertaining environment are what make 285 Camino Pablo memorable. A relaunch needs to open with that story - visually and in writing - before it introduces the kitchen or the floor plan. Buyers who feel the setting first arrive at showings already oriented toward the home. BrightWork's Sky Tour gives that context immediately, in a format no ground photo can replicate. The interior is strong. The setting is the differentiator.

Pillar II - Build the Narrative That Justifies the Number

This home was listed below the Orinda renovated benchmark, which means the price was never the obstacle. The obstacle was a listing description that inventoried features without telling a coherent story. A buyer considering \$1,249,000 in Orinda needs to understand specifically why this home, this lot, and this renovation add up to something they can't find elsewhere. BrightWork writes listing remarks the way a great buyer's agent describes a property - with a point of view, not a checklist. Buyers who understand the value before they arrive make stronger offers.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyers Who Are Already Looking for This

The buyer for 285 Camino Pablo is likely a professional relocating from San Francisco or the inner East Bay who is researching Orinda online, narrowing options before they commit to weekend showings. That buyer shops by feel before they shop by spec - they need to experience this home digitally before they'll drive out to see it. BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through the home from anywhere, at any hour, so the first real impression is the full impression. Busy professionals and out-of-area buyers don't wait for open houses. The home needs to be ready when they are.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727 · 455 Moraga Road, Suite I, Moraga, CA 94556